SARAH-LYNNE VAN DER MERWE

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

Commercially minded business and retail leader with experience in operational management, customer engagement, brand development and team coordination. Combines an entrepreneurial mindset with a strong interest in practical business improvement, stakeholder communication and customer-centred service delivery. Comfortable translating broad business goals into clear, visible initiatives.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Founder & Principal Consultant | Sarah-Lynne Consulting
2022–Present
• Established and lead an independent consultancy focused on brand positioning, customer engagement and practical business-improvement initiatives.
• Develop client-facing brand concepts, communication materials and engagement strategies tailored to business needs.
• Manage the consulting process end to end, including concept development, stakeholder communication and delivery coordination.
• Build audience engagement through consistent professional content and thought-leadership activity across digital channels.

Senior Retail Team Leader | Retail Store
2018–2022
• Supported end-to-end daily retail operations, including opening and closing procedures, stock oversight and team coordination.
• Improved customer experience by reinforcing service standards and coaching team members on approachable, responsive interactions.
• Assisted with stock accuracy and operational planning through regular inventory review and in-store organisation.
• Led team meetings and contributed to a structured, accountable working environment.

EDUCATION & DEVELOPMENT

Business Administration Studies
Coursework in business operations, management and commercial fundamentals

Executive Leadership Development
Independent study in leadership, entrepreneurship and business strategy

CORE COMPETENCIES

• Business development and brand positioning
• Retail operations and team leadership
• Customer experience improvement
• Stakeholder communication
• Strategic planning and initiative delivery
• Digital content and community engagement
• Inventory and operational coordination

RECOGNITION

• Employee of the Month — September 2019
• Recognised for strong participation in organisational initiatives and employee engagement activities

REFERENCES

Available on request.